

WITH DETECTIVE HOLLOWAY'S COMPLIMENTS

THE HOLLOWMERE

BONUS CASE FILE



Six brand-new cosy cases for All Hallows' Eve, free for every reader — with full solutions. Read each case, work the word search, and let the unused letters name the guilty. No sign-up, no catch. Mind the dark.

Death at the Cellar

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



ONE PAIR OF eyes had seen too much — MISS CHEEVER, who walked the old dog at dawn without fail, in the Cellar, the Letteropener lifted in the dark — and would not meet Holloway's gaze. A wreath of bittersweet and autumn leaves still hung on the door, out of place now. Holloway considered the three who remained behind. Pudding, the inspector's marmalade cat, sat washing one paw on the sill, supremely unbothered. Enid, the member, had lost the same prize to the dead three harvests running, had stepped out alone and told no one where, and could palm the Letteropener without a soul noticing. Gladys, the rival, had been thrown over after years of loyal service, was vouched for by two stewards beyond any doubt, and had kept to the edges of the trouble. Stanley, the secretary, slipped from sight in the very hour of the death, knew the Letteropener and could lay hands on it in a moment, and had every reason to wish the victim well. It was the kind of village Holloway had grown up in, and she felt the loss of it. One curtain-tie had been sliced rather than untied — and the answer was plain.

THE SUSPECTS

Enid (the member), **Gladys** (the rival), **Stanley** (the secretary)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. I — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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I	T	E	C	A	L	P	E	R	I	F	W
W	A	S	L	A	U	R	E	L	S	E	A
W	A	G	E	R	B	O	O	K	N	I	G
D	B	A	C	K	G	A	M	M	O	N	E
L	E	T	T	E	R	O	P	E	N	E	R
W	I	T	A	X	O	B	F	F	U	N	S
H	T	H	N	E	S	E	T	U	N	I	M
L	E	T	T	T	E	R	O	P	E	N	E
R	A	E	A	V	E	S	D	R	O	P	T
C	E	L	L	A	R	E	N	T	R	A	P
T	H	E	U	S	E	O	N	I	M	O	D
C	E	L	S	L	A	R	B	A	I	Z	E

BACKGAMMON	EAVESDROP	MINUTES	WAGER-BOOK
BAIZE	FIREPLACE	PARTNER	WAGERS
CELLAR	LAURELS	SNUFFBOX	
DOMINOES	LETTEROPENER	TANTALUS	

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

The Study Affair

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



SOMEONE HAD BEEN watching when MRS. ROOKE, who never missed a christening, died in the Study by the Statuette, though they would say little to Holloway. Carved turnip-lanterns guttered on every sill, their grins gone solemn. On the dresser, Pudding curled into a comma and kept one amber eye open. Three had the run of the old manor that day, and Holloway questioned each in turn. Yolande, the heiress, kept a past the dead alone could prove, had little enough to say for herself, and found the Statuette already gone before it could be fetched. Genevieve, the gardener, owed the dead more than the shop was worth, was both near enough and strong enough to take up the Statuette, and offered an account of the hour that seemed, at first, to hold. Susannah, the cook, was nowhere anyone could name when it happened, was well placed to seize the Statuette the moment it was wanted, and was already paid in full and had nothing left to settle. It was a small thing that gave it away: a smear had been wiped from the mantel and missed one corner.

THE SUSPECTS

Yolande (the heiress), **Genevieve** (the gardener), **Susannah** (the cook)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. II — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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R	I	T	E	G	W	S	A	R	S	R	G
E	M	P	X	A	E	T	N	U	E	E	S
I	A	M	P	Z	V	A	Y	O	I	T	W
L	R	A	O	E	E	T	D	L	V	S	E
E	K	L	S	B	E	U	U	R	W	I	E
D	E	S	U	O	H	E	T	A	G	N	T
N	R	A	R	I	T	T	S	P	H	A	H
A	T	G	E	H	E	T	S	T	A	B	E
H	T	U	E	T	T	E	E	A	T	T	A
C	D	N	A	T	S	K	N	I	H	E	R
S	O	R	A	N	G	E	R	Y	T	U	T
E	R	I	O	T	I	R	C	S	E	D	Y

BANISTER	GASLAMP	MARKER	STUDY
CHANDELIER	GATEHOUSE	ORANGERY	SWEETHEART
ESCRITOIRE	GAZEBO	PARLOUR	
EXPOSURE	INKSTAND	STATUETTE	

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

Trouble at the Green

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR



THE CRY WENT up across the harvest fete before anyone could think — MR. PLUMB — who walked the long way round to greet the lonely — fallen on the Green, the Poison at hand. Somewhere an owl called, and bonfire smoke hung low over the green. Holloway's cat Pudding wound once about a table-leg and settled in to watch. Holloway called the fete-warden and the rest together, and listened. Edmund, the beekeeper, had the run of the still-room where the Poison was stored, was missed by every eye when it mattered most, and depended on the victim's goodwill and knew it well. Honoria, the baker, stood to inherit the cottage on Marsh Lane, was no great hand at hiding feeling, and had no way to reach the Poison unwatched. Adelaide, the vicar, could not forgive being passed over for the dead, held the keys to where the Poison was locked away, and professed to have stood among the others the whole while. Vincent, the grocer, had lost the same prize to the dead three harvests running, was known to the dead of old, and could not have slipped away unseen by a crowd at the tombola. Holloway had her answer the moment she saw it: a faint chalky residue ringed the inside of one tumbler.

THE SUSPECTS

Vincent (the grocer), **Honoria** (the baker), **Adelaide** (the vicar),
Edmund (the beekeeper)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer
Weapon
Location
VI

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A June Holloway Casebook

CASE NO. III — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR

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I	T	S	W	W	S	A	L	P	O	O	H
A	S	E	A	H	T	Y	H	P	O	R	T
S	D	D	E	E	U	L	A	I	S	S	Y
E	V	I	D	E	N	C	E	E	N	E	C
N	N	R	D	L	O	E	G	L	O	T	A
O	O	Y	W	R	C	I	R	O	B	T	G
C	S	N	T	A	O	H	E	P	B	E	E
S	I	O	T	C	C	H	E	Y	I	S	L
E	O	P	P	E	O	I	N	A	R	O	S
O	P	N	N	O	I	T	O	M	O	R	P
T	O	M	B	O	L	A	A	T	T	H	E
G	R	E	B	U	N	T	I	N	G	E	N

BUNTING

HOOPLA

PONY-RIDES

SCONES

COCONUTS

LEGACY

PROMOTION

TOMBOLA

EVIDENCE

MAYPOLE

RIBBONS

TROPHY

GREEN

POISON

ROSETTES

WHEEL-RACE

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

The Chapel Case

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR



IT WAS THE fete-warden who met Holloway at the door, white-faced: CANON REEVE, who kept the churchyard tidy unasked, was in the Chapel, and the Poison had done its work. A jack-o'-lantern grinned on the gatepost, its candle nearly spent. There were four who could have done it, and Holloway weighed them one against another. Pudding, the inspector's marmalade cat, sat washing one paw on the sill, supremely unbothered. Mercy, the judge, blamed the dead for the fire that took the old mill, could have laid hands on the Poison, and was caught in conversation by the brass band and could not break free. Romola, the grocer, could not forgive being passed over for the dead, had no hand in preparing what the victim drank, and was reckoned harmless enough by all. Leopold, the beekeeper, would have been finished if the truth ever came out, prepared the very dish the Poison was found in, and claimed to have been safely elsewhere when it happened. Winnifred, the baker, could reach the Poison and the cup both, unwatched, could name no one who saw her at the hour, and was already paid in full and had nothing left to settle. It was a small thing that gave it away: the decanter had been topped up with something paler than the rest.

THE SUSPECTS

Leopold (the beekeeper), **Mercy** (the judge), **Romola** (the grocer), **Winnifred** (the baker)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer
Weapon
Location
VIII

CASE NO. IV — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — INSPECTOR

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I	A	L	O	B	M	O	T	T	T	A	W
T	I	N	S	T	A	L	M	E	N	T	A
E	S	S	L	E	O	P	A	A	D	O	L
A	P	W	D	W	I	T	H	A	N	D	T
C	H	O	T	H	E	K	T	E	A	I	E
A	P	R	N	N	M	T	O	I	B	S	L
K	S	R	T	Y	E	O	N	A	S	G	O
E	T	A	G	D	R	T	H	E	S	R	P
S	C	M	N	O	S	I	O	P	A	A	Y
H	L	E	P	A	H	C	D	A	R	C	A
P	V	A	L	P	O	O	H	E	B	E	M
A	F	F	E	C	T	I	O	N	S	E	L

AFFECTION	GYMKHANA	MAYPOLE	TEATENT
BRASS-BAND	HOOPLA	POISON	TOMBOLA
CHAPEL	INSTALMENT	PONY-RIDES	VENDETTA
DISGRACE	MARROWS	TEACAKES	

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

Murder at the Conservatory

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



"None of us can quite believe it," said the housekeeper; and yet MISS TOLLER, who left the gate oiled so it never woke the street, lay dead in the Conservatory, the Bookend the cause. Toffee apples sat untouched on the trestle, going slowly dull. Holloway gathered the three who had been near. Pudding, the inspector's marmalade cat, sat washing one paw on the sill, supremely unbothered. Zachary, the cook, had a buried scandal the victim threatened to unearth, had been laid up with a turned ankle since dawn, and kept much to his own affairs. Lionel, the butler, had been at the weir the night the boy drowned, and the dead knew it, was absent from every gathering in that hour, and had the Bookend closer to hand than anyone in the house. Honoria, the solicitor, had handled the Bookend a hundred times and could again, had wandered off alone just as the clock struck, and had every reason to wish the victim well. She had seen grief enough to know the genuine article from the performed. Holloway bent closer. A chair-leg had scored a bright arc across the boards.

THE SUSPECTS

Lionel (the butler), **Honoria** (the solicitor), **Zachary** (the cook)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. V — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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K	I	B	T	C	W	A	D	S	L	I	O
C	D	O	P	O	R	T	R	A	I	T	G
A	E	O	N	N	E	L	E	W	I	A	A
B	H	K	T	S	H	T	S	L	H	P	T
Y	S	E	E	E	B	O	S	A	L	E	E
A	U	N	O	R	K	E	I	I	I	S	H
P	H	D	N	V	D	A	N	D	C	T	O
T	H	T	R	A	E	H	G	N	I	R	U
M	O	O	R	T	O	O	B	U	D	Y	S
E	R	U	S	O	P	X	E	S	O	T	E
H	E	C	Y	R	E	L	L	U	C	S	O
N	S	E	R	Y	V	A	L	T	O	R	Y

BOOKEND

DRESSING-BELL

HUSHED

SUNDIAL

BOOTROOM

EXPOSURE

PAYBACK

TAPESTRY

CODICIL

GATEHOUSE

PORTRAIT

CONSERVATORY

HEARTH

SCULLERY

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

A Death in the Orchard

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE



"None of us can quite believe it," said the fete-warden; and yet MR. BOWDEN, who saved newspaper for the chip shop, lay dead in the Orchard, the Hatpin the cause. A harvest moon hung low and orange behind the bare elms. Pudding, the inspector's marmalade cat, sat washing one paw on the sill, supremely unbothered. Holloway gathered the three who had been near. Ursula, the baker, saw the contract slipping to the victim's hands, could reach the Hatpin unwatched when the moment came, and had no soul to vouch for her whereabouts. Sylvia, the vicar, had only to reach out for the Hatpin, and could, kept to the shadows in the very hour it was done, and was the dead man's heir to nothing and knew it. Perpetua, the grocer, had a buried scandal the victim threatened to unearth, was reckoned a quiet sort, and found the Hatpin already gone before it could be fetched. Holloway bent closer. A single bright bead of blood marked one tiny puncture.

THE SUSPECTS

Ursula (the baker), **Sylvia** (the vicar), **Perpetua** (the grocer)

YOUR VERDICT

Killer

Weapon

Location

CASE NO. VI — THE PUZZLE

DIFFICULTY — CONSTABLE

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I	E	G	A	T	O	B	A	S	T	W	A
A	L	O	B	M	O	T	S	C	U	R	S
N	I	P	T	A	H	L	U	A	T	L	G
N	A	W	I	T	H	L	T	R	R	D	Y
O	D	I	S	G	R	A	C	E	E	N	M
I	H	E	H	A	T	T	P	C	S	A	K
T	S	E	T	T	E	S	O	R	T	B	H
O	T	N	E	T	A	E	T	O	L	S	A
M	I	N	A	T	T	K	H	W	E	S	N
O	E	G	A	R	L	A	N	D	S	A	A
R	A	F	F	L	E	C	O	R	C	R	H
P	D	R	A	H	C	R	O	A	R	B	D

BRASS-BAND	GYMKHANA	RAFFLE	TEATENT
CAKE-STALL	HATPIN	ROSETTES	TOMBOLA
DISGRACE	ORCHARD	SABOTAGE	TRESTLES
GARLANDS	PROMOTION	SCARECROW	

Every word hides once. The unused letters spell the verdict.

Solutions

Case 1: Enid

Holloway cleared the rest in turn: Gladys was vouched for by two stewards beyond any doubt. That left two who might have done it — Stanley and Enid — each with the means to reach the Letteropener and no account of the hour. But Stanley had no quarrel with the dead; Enid alone joined a bitter rivalry to the means and the chance. The unused letters confirm it: IT WAS ENID WITH THE LETTEROPENER AT THE CELLAR.

Case 2: Genevieve

Holloway cleared the others first: Yolande found the Statuette already gone before it could be fetched. Genevieve seemed accounted for too — yet a smear had been wiped from the mantel and missed one corner, and that placed Genevieve at the Study after all, alibi or no. Susannah shared the means and the missing hour but had no quarrel with the dead; only Genevieve carried a motive — a debt owed. The unused letters confirm it: IT WAS GENEVIEVE WITH THE STATUETTE AT THE STUDY.

Case 3: Adelaide

Holloway cleared the others first: Vincent could not have slipped away unseen by a crowd at the tombola; Honoria had no way to reach the Poison unwatched. Adelaide seemed accounted for too — yet a faint chalky residue ringed the inside of one tumbler, and that placed Adelaide at the Green after all, alibi or no. Edmund shared the means and the missing hour but had no quarrel with the dead; only Adelaide carried a motive — jealousy. The unused letters confirm it: IT WAS ADELAIDE WITH THE POISON AT THE GREEN.

Case 4: Leopold

Holloway cleared the others first: Mercy was caught in conversation by the brass band and could not break free; Romola had no hand in preparing what the victim drank. Leopold seemed accounted for too — yet the decanter had been topped up with something paler than the rest, and that placed Leopold at the Chapel after all, alibi or no. Winnifred shared the means and the missing hour but had no quarrel with the dead; only Leopold carried a motive — the fear of exposure. The unused letters confirm it: IT WAS LEOPOLD WITH THE POISON AT THE CHAPEL.

Case 5: Lionel

The others fell away one by one: Zachary had been laid up with a turned ankle since dawn. Two were left holding both the means and the missing hour — Honoria and Lionel. Yet Honoria stood to gain nothing by the death; only Lionel carried silencing a witness as well. Means and chance they shared; the motive was Lionel's alone. The unused letters confirm it: IT WAS LIONEL WITH THE BOOKEND AT THE CONSERVATORY.

Case 6: Ursula

Holloway set them side by side: Perpetua found the Hatpin already gone before it could be fetched. Sylvia and Ursula both could have reached the Hatpin unseen and could not say where they had stood — but a hand needs a reason. Sylvia had none worth the name; Ursula had sabotage. The unused letters confirm it: IT WAS URSULA WITH THE HATPIN AT THE ORCHARD.